

Ohio River Trail Council
BC Council of Governments
December 13, 2018
Welcome



*Stephanie Burch
Center Township*

Ohio River Trail Council

Beaver County Council of Governments

Dr. Vincent Troia, CEO



Ohio River Trail Council BC COG Presentation



Topics

- ▶ Pittsburgh Trail Network
- ▶ State Bicycle Routes
- ▶ Regional Trail Coalition
- ▶ National Bicycle System
- ▶ Ohio River Trail Council Programs

Pittsburgh Trail Network

Ohio River Greenway Trail

Dr. Vincent Troia, CEO





Pittsburgh Trail Network

Ohio River Greenway Trail

Trail Connections

Pittsburgh Trail Network

Ohio River Trail

Three Rivers Heritage Trail

Allegheny River Trail

Panhandle Trail

Montour Trail

Steel Valley Trail
GAP

242

250

51

86

206

30

Monaca

Economy

Aliquippa

Legionville

Ambridge

Frank Park

Butler
Allegheny

Scouts Trail - Harrison Hills Park

Tredway Trail

Tarentum

Arnold

Lower Burrell

New Kensington

Allegheny Islands State Park
Oakmont

Plum

Raccoon Creek State Park Trails

Hillman State Park Trails

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Airport Link Trail

Three Rivers Water Trail

McKees Rocks

Great Allegheny Passage - Montour Trail

Panhandle Trail

22

Crafton

Carnegie

19

Baldwin

Great Allegheny Passage - Montour Trail - Arrowhead Trail

Canonsburg

Pittsburgh

Wilkinsburg

Swissvale

Turtle Creek

76

Munhall

Bethel Park

Whitehall

West Mifflin

White Oak

Jefferson

Clairton

Steel Valley Trail - Great Allegheny Passage

Jeannette

Five Star Trail

Pittsburgh Trail Network *Ohio River Greenway Trail*



Trail Connections

- ▶ The Ohio River Greenway Trail (ORGT) is a key segment of a "major" greenway corridor being developed in the "Keystone State" that completes an important section in the Pittsburgh Trail Network.

Pittsburgh Trail Network

Ohio River Greenway Trail



Trail Connections

- ▶ Allegheny River Trail
- ▶ Great Allegheny Passage
- ▶ Montour Trail
- ▶ Panhandle Trail
- ▶ Steel Valley Trail
- ▶ Three Rivers Heritage Trail

Coraopolis, Pa

Ohio River Trail

Montour Street

4th Ave

**INTERSECTION IMPROVEMENTS AT NEVILLE
ISLAND BRIDGE AND 4TH AVE: CROSSWALKS &
ADA IMPROVEMENTS**

**CONSTRUCT NEW RAMP & EMBANKMENT
ALONG AT EXISTING RETAINING WALL;
10'-12" WIDTH TRAIL, 2-WAY TRAVEL**

**Montour Trail
Connector**

**Three Rivers Heritage
Trail Connector**

**MONTOUR JUNCTION
SPORTS COMPLEX PROPERTY**

**EXTEND TRAIL BENEATH NEVILLE ISLAND
BRIDGE TO MONTOUR ST.; 10' WIDTH
TRAIL, 2-WAY TRAVEL**

**BACK CHANNEL OF THE
OHIO RIVER**

Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



Three Rivers Heritage Trail Connection

- At the southern terminus the Ohio River Greenway Trail (ORGT) links to Allegheny County's Three Rivers Heritage Trail at the Neville Island Bridge via the Coraopolis to Pittsburgh Southside Connector.



Three Rivers Heritage Trail Coraopolis to Pittsburgh Southside Connector



Neville Island Bridge

51

Mackin

FRIENDS of the RIVERFRONT

Pittsburgh Trail Network *Ohio River Greenway Trail*



Three Rivers Heritage Trail Connection

- The Three Rivers Heritage Trail connection is completed between Coraopolis and the Southside of Pittsburgh, Pa.



Pittsburgh Trail Network

Ohio River Greenway Trail



Montour Trail Connection

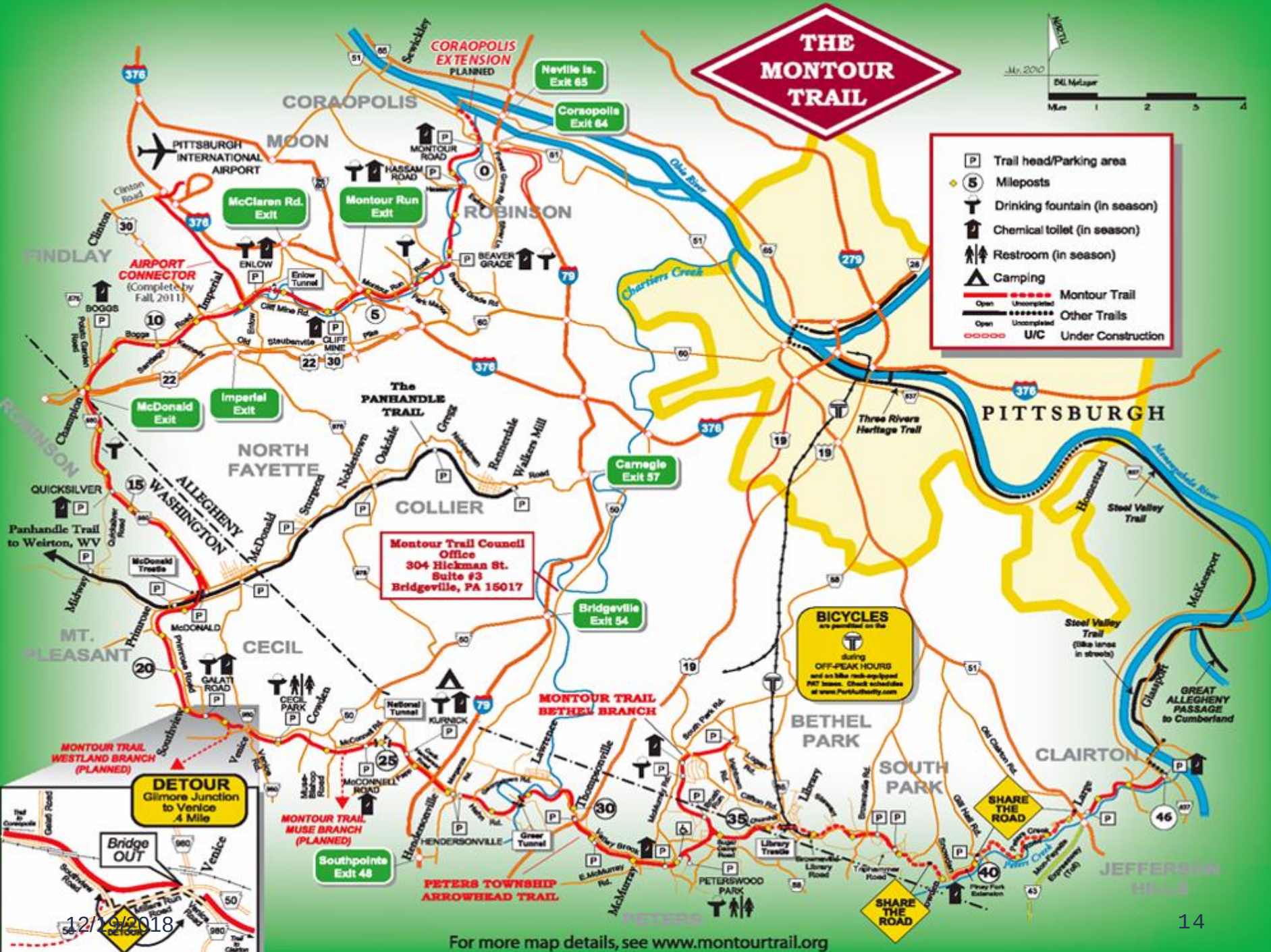
- ▶ The Ohio River Greenway Trail southern terminus connects to the Montour Trail at Montour Street & 4th Ave, Coraopolis Pa.



THE MONTOUR TRAIL



- Trail head/Parking area
- Mileposts
- Drinking fountain (in season)
- Chemical toilet (in season)
- Restroom (in season)
- Camping
- Montour Trail
- Other Trails
- U/C Under Construction



Montour Trail Council Office
 304 Hickman St.
 Suite #3
 Bridgeville, PA 15017

BICYCLES
 are permitted on the
 trail during
 OFF-PEAK HOURS
 and on bike rack-equipped
 P&T lanes. Check schedules
 at www.ParkAuthority.com



THE
MONTOUR
TRAIL



Montour Trail
McDonald Viaduct

State Bicycle Routes

Pennsylvania Bike Routes PennDOT

Dr. Vincent Troia, CEO



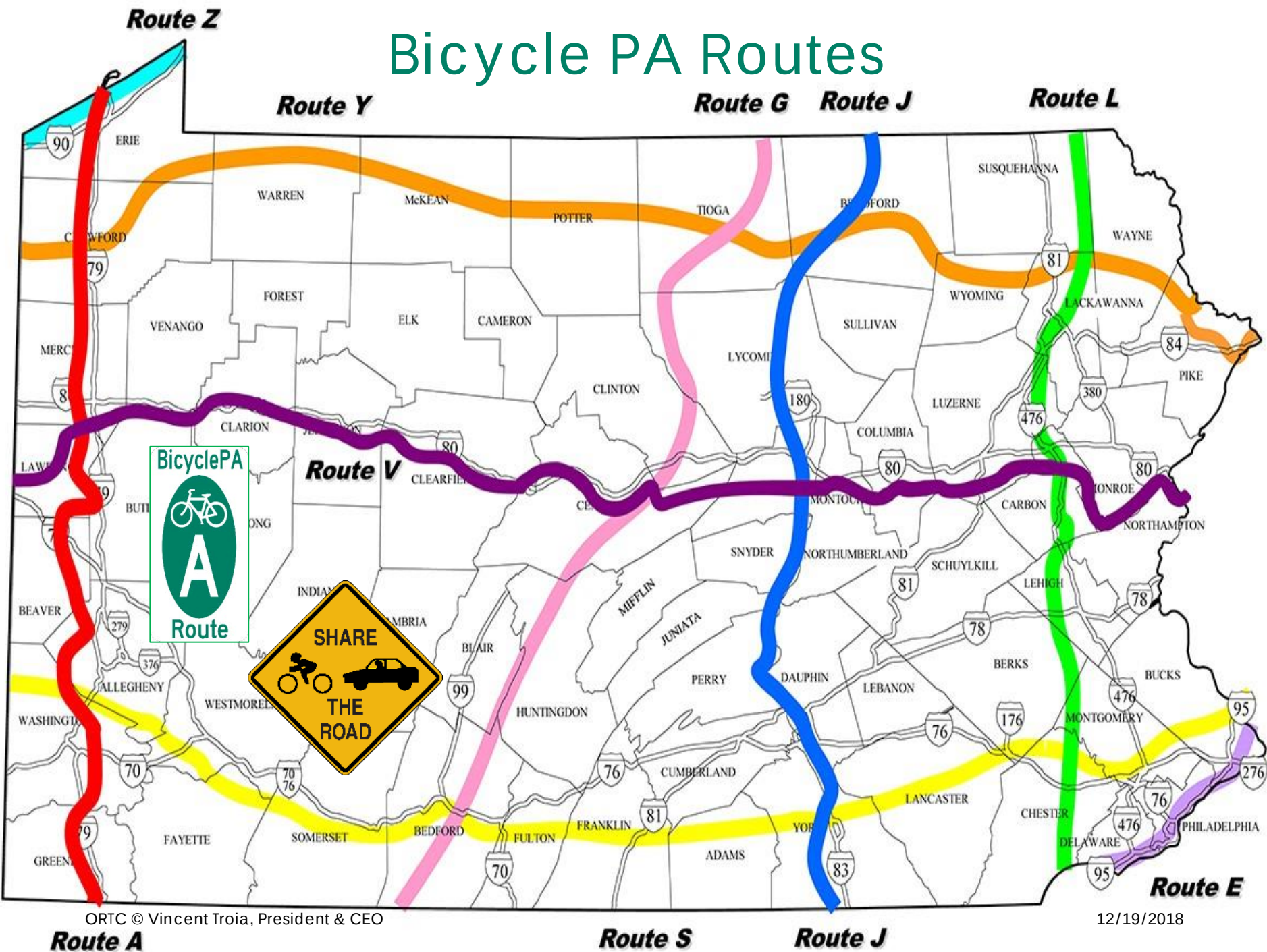


State Bicycle Routes

Pennsylvania Bike Routes

Pa Bike Route A

Bicycle PA Routes





State Bicycle Routes

Pennsylvania Bike Routes

Pa Bike Route A
Elwood City to Coraopolis

Pennsylvania Bike Routes

PA Bike Route A



Local Municipalities

- ▶ Elwood City
- ▶ Eastvale
- ▶ Beaver Falls
- ▶ New Brighton
- ▶ Rochester Twp.
- ▶ Rochester
- ▶ Monaca
- ▶ Center Twp.
- ▶ Aliquippa*
- ▶ Hopewell*
- ▶ South Heights
- ▶ Crescent Twp.
- ▶ Moon Twp.*
- ▶ Coraopolis



Pennsylvania Bike Routes

PA Bike Route A



Bicycling & Motorists Safety

- ▶ Bicycle PA Route A directs cyclists onto 50-55 mph, four lane highways—State Route 18, 51, and 65.
- ▶ Four cycling fatalities have occurred in on Route 51 in the last 4 years.



Pennsylvania Bike Routes

PA Bike Route A



Bike PA Route A Alternate Route

- The Ohio River Greenway Trail parallels Bike PA Route A (Route 51) in Allegheny and Beaver County between Coraopolis and New Brighton to provide a safer alternative.



BicyclePA



Bicycle PA Route A

PAGE 11

New Castle



Scale
1:65,000

0 0.5 1 2 Miles
0 0.5 1 2 Kilometers

12/19/2018

BicyclePA

Bicycle PA Route A

PAGE 10



Eastvale

Beaver Falls



12/19/2018

Scale
1:65,000
0 0.5 1 Miles
0 0.5 1 2 Kilometers

BicyclePA



A

Route

Bicycle PA Route A

PAGE 9

Rochester

Monaca

Aliquippa



Scale
1:65,000
0 0.5 1 Miles
0 0.5 1 2 Kilometers



© 2018



*Bike PA Route A
Route 51 South*

Bicycle PA Route A

PAGE 8



Scale
1:65,000
0 0.5 1 Miles
0 0.5 1 2 Kilometers



Hopewell
Township

Crescent
Township

Coraopolis &
Moon Township



PAGE 7



Route

Miles

Kilometers



12/19/2018

Noblestown



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*Bike PA Route A
Montour Trail*

Regional Trail Coalition

Industrial Heartland Trail

Dr. Vincent Troia, CEO





Regional Trail Coalition

Industrial Heartland Trail

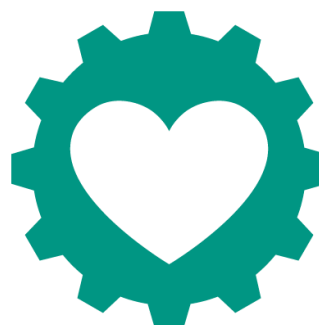
Five-State Coalition

Regional Trail Coalition Industrial Heartland Trail



Industrial Heartland Trail Coalition

- ▶ The 1,600-mile regional network includes 53 counties in 5-states and is 53% complete.



Industrial
**Heartland
Trails**
COALITION

THE NETWORK - STATUS POWER OF 32 REGIONAL TRAIL SYSTEM 2013 REGIONAL TRAIL STAKEHOLDERS MEETING



The Network

- Existing Trails (green line)
- Planned or Proposed Trails (orange line)
- Missing Gaps (red line)

LEGEND

- Study Area Boundary (grey outline)
- State Boundary (white outline)
- County Boundary (thin grey outline)
- Major City (black dot)

TRAILS

- On-Road Trails (green line with 'X' markers)
- On-Road Trails (orange line with 'X' markers)
- Single Track Trails (green line with 'V' markers)
- Water Trails (blue line)

MEGA TRAIL CORRIDORS

CLEVELAND TO ERIE MEGA CORRIDOR

LINE	SECTION	ROUTE	TYPE	STATUS
1	1	Cleveland to Strongsville	On-Road	Existing
1	2	Strongsville to Akron	On-Road	Existing
1	3	Akron to Youngstown	On-Road	Existing
1	4	Youngstown to Ashtabula	On-Road	Existing
1	5	Ashtabula to Erie	On-Road	Existing

AKRON TO PITTSBURGH MEGA CORRIDOR

LINE	SECTION	ROUTE	TYPE	STATUS
2	1	Akron to Youngstown	On-Road	Existing
2	2	Youngstown to Warren	On-Road	Existing
2	3	Warren to Pittsburgh	On-Road	Existing

INDIANAPOLIS TO PITTSBURGH MEGA CORRIDOR

LINE	SECTION	ROUTE	TYPE	STATUS
3	1	Indianapolis to Greensburg	On-Road	Existing
3	2	Greensburg to Pittsburgh	On-Road	Existing

MEGA TRAIL CORRIDORS (CONT.)

PA WILSON CONNECTOR MEGA CORRIDOR

LINE	SECTION	ROUTE	TYPE	STATUS
4	1	PA Wilson to Erie	On-Road	Existing
4	2	Erie to PA Wilson	On-Road	Existing

PITTSBURGH TO ASHTABULA MEGA CORRIDOR

LINE	SECTION	ROUTE	TYPE	STATUS
5	1	Pittsburgh to Youngstown	On-Road	Existing
5	2	Youngstown to Ashtabula	On-Road	Existing

PITTSBURGH TO CLEVELAND MEGA CORRIDOR

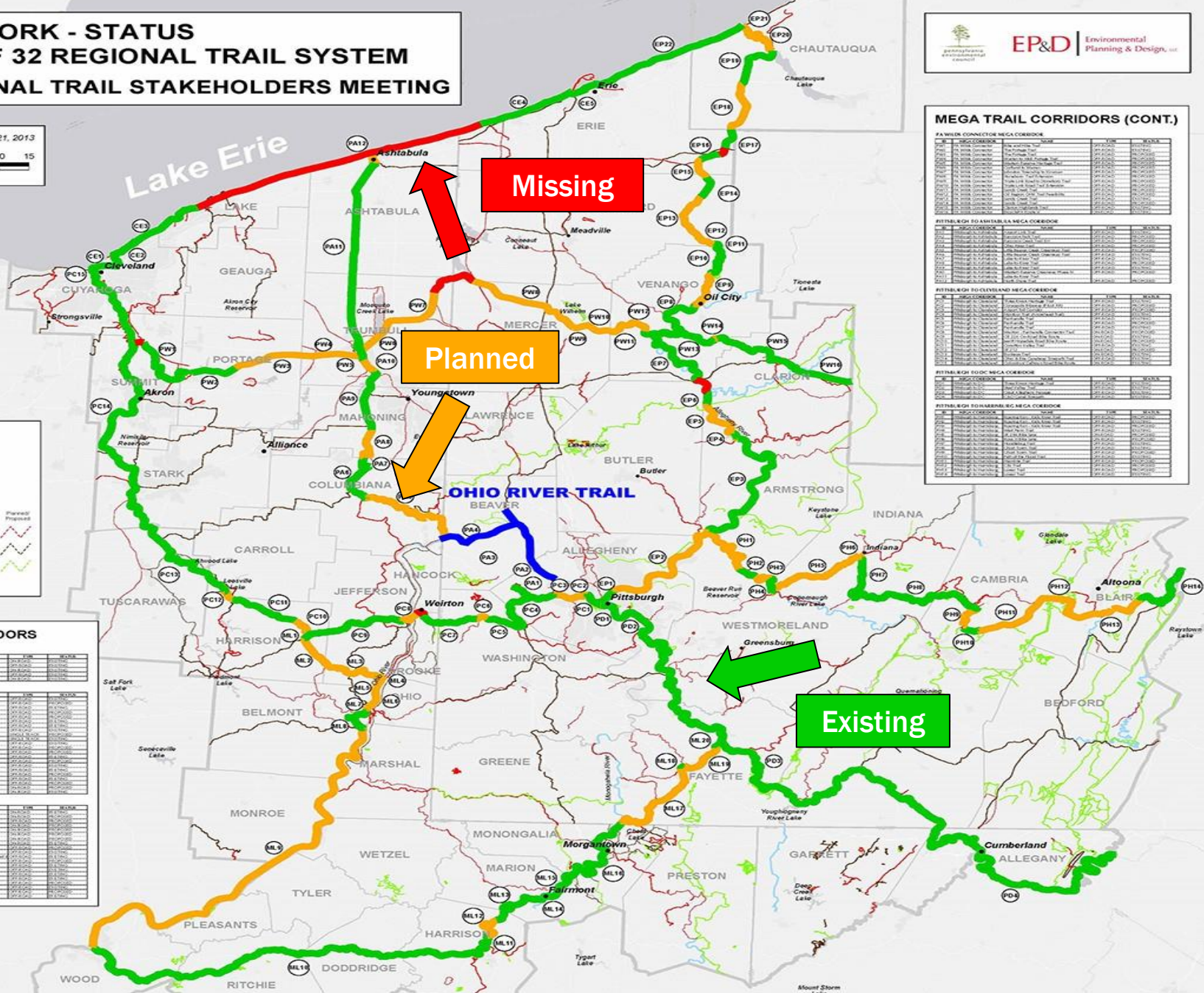
LINE	SECTION	ROUTE	TYPE	STATUS
6	1	Pittsburgh to Warren	On-Road	Existing
6	2	Warren to Akron	On-Road	Existing
6	3	Akron to Cleveland	On-Road	Existing

PITTSBURGH TO DC MEGA CORRIDOR

LINE	SECTION	ROUTE	TYPE	STATUS
7	1	Pittsburgh to Greensburg	On-Road	Existing
7	2	Greensburg to DC	On-Road	Existing

PITTSBURGH TO HARRISBURG MEGA CORRIDOR

LINE	SECTION	ROUTE	TYPE	STATUS
8	1	Pittsburgh to Harrisburg	On-Road	Existing



Regional Trail Coalition Industrial Heartland Trail



Industrial Heartland Trail Coalition

► GoToTrails - www.GoToTrails.info



Regional Trail Network

Lake Erie

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Industrial
Heartland
Trails

Ohio River
Trail



CLEVELAND

AKRON

ERIE

PITTSBURGH

MORGANTOWN

PARKERSBURG



Regional Trail Coalition

Industrial Heartland Trail

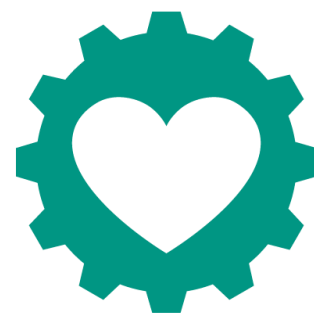
Ohio River Greenway Trail

Regional Trail Coalition Industrial Heartland Trail



Ohio River Greenway Trail

- ▶ The Ohio River Greenway Trail is a central component of the Industrial Heartland Trail Network and the two-state Pittsburgh to Ashtabula and Cleveland Trail.



Industrial
Heartland
Trails



Regional Trail Coalition

Industrial Heartland Trail

Pittsburgh Connections

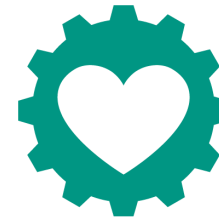
Regional Trail Coalition Industrial Heartland Trail



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Pittsburgh Connections

- ▶ Ashtabula, Ohio to Pittsburgh
- ▶ Cleveland to Pittsburgh
- ▶ Erie, Pa to Pittsburgh
- ▶ Parkersburg, WV to Pittsburgh
- ▶ Wheeling, WV to Pittsburgh



Industrial
Heartland
Trails
COALITION



Regional Trail Coalition

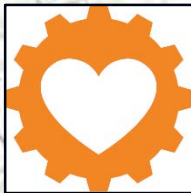
Industrial Heartland Trail

Ashtabula to Pittsburgh

Beaver County
IHTC Trail Network

Ohio River Trail

Little Beaver
Creek Greenway



Industrial
Heartland
Trails

Proposed
Raccoon Creek
Greenway Trail

Airport

Montour
Trail



Regional Trail Coalition Ashtabula to Pittsburgh



Ohio River Greenway Trail

- ▶ Links the “Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway” in Columbiana County, Ohio to the “Great Allegheny Passage” in Allegheny County, Pa and the C&O Canal Towpath, forming a mega-trail system of over 500-miles from the Great Lakes region to the east coast.

Regional Trail Coalition Ashtabula to Pittsburgh



Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway

- ▶ 110-mile trail from Ashtabula, Ohio to Ohioville, Pennsylvania.
- ▶ Lake Erie to the Ohio River.
- ▶ 80% complete.

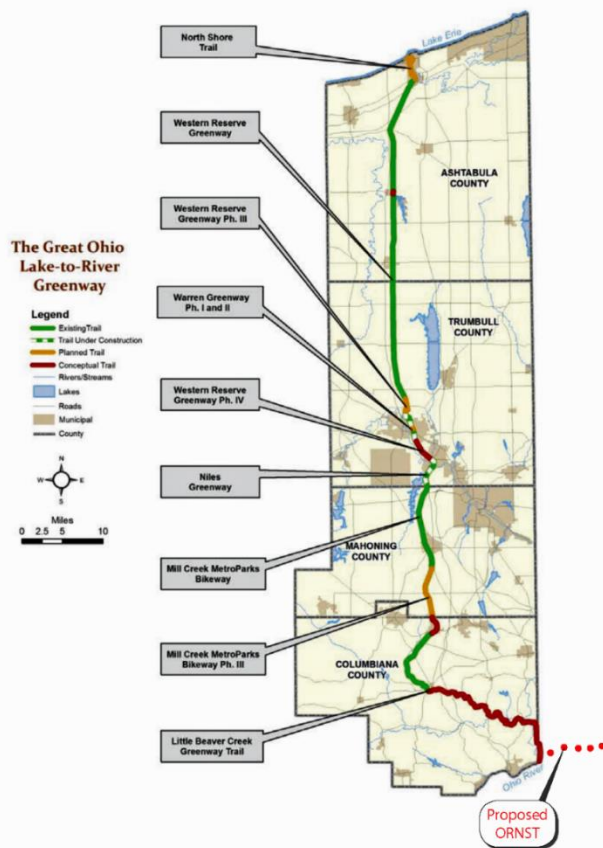


Regional Trail Coalition Ashtabula to Pittsburgh



Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway Connection

► The Ohio River
Greenway Trail will
connect to the Little
Beaver Creek
Greenway at the
“Point of Beginning”



Regional Trail Coalition Ashtabula to Pittsburgh



Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway

- ▶ The “Point of Beginning” is a marker from which the U.S. Public Land Survey System was performed.
- ▶ Located near the three-way intersection of Ohio, Pa, and the northern tip of West Virginia

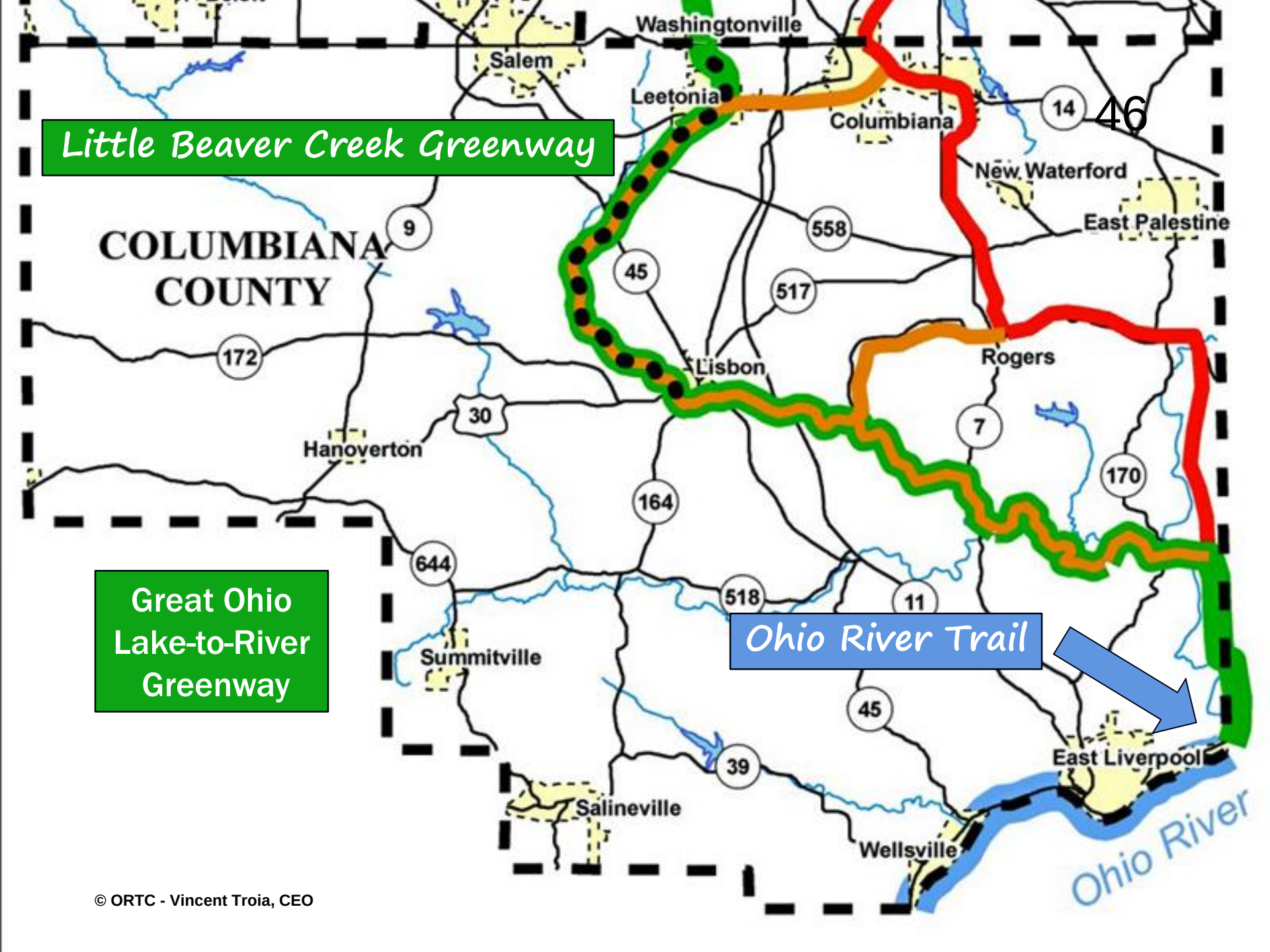


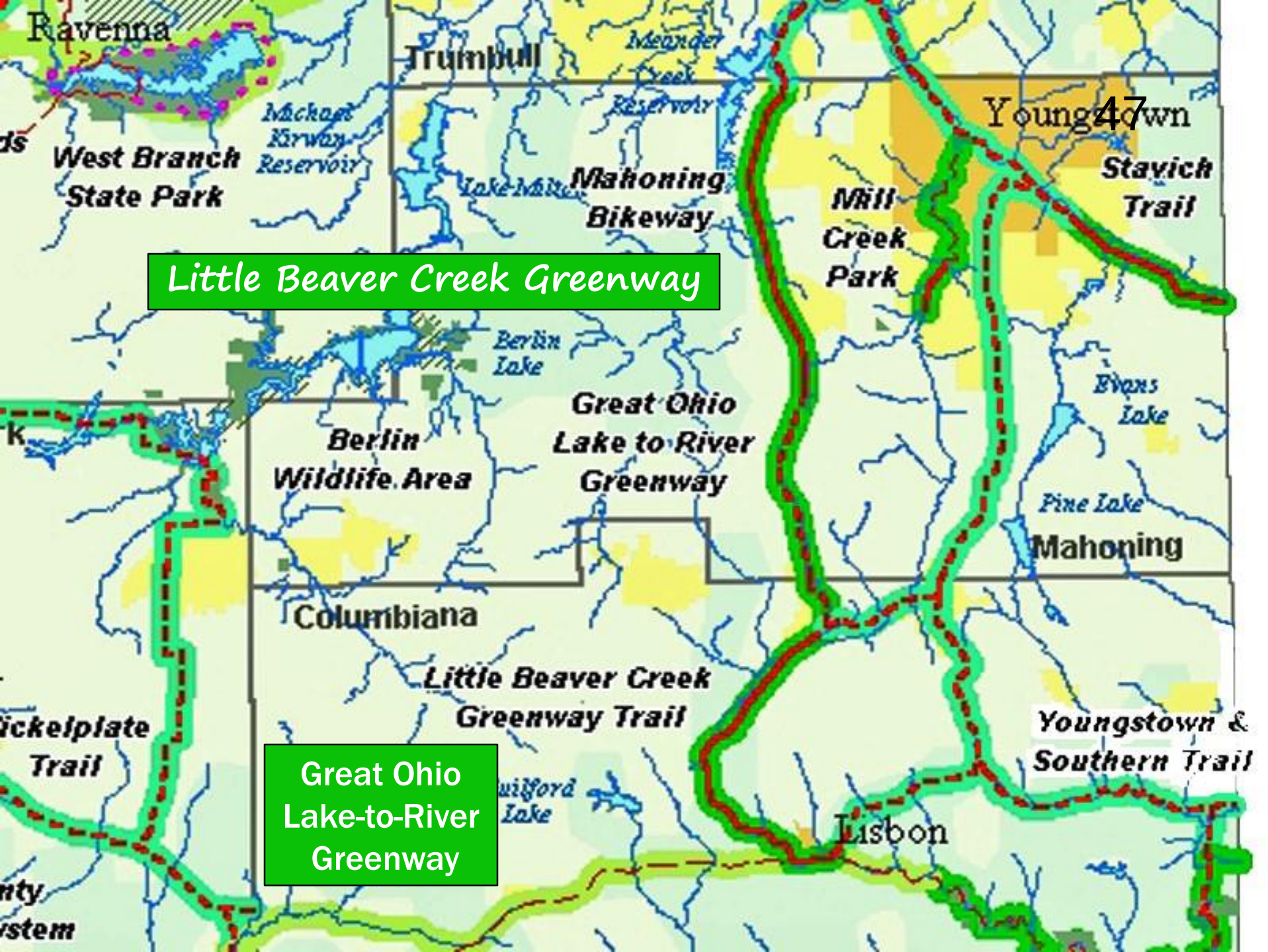
Little Beaver Creek Greenway

**COLUMBIANA
COUNTY**

**Great Ohio
Lake-to-River
Greenway**

Ohio River Trail





Little Beaver Creek Greenway

**Great Ohio
Lake-to-River
Greenway**

A paved path leads through a forest. On the left, there is a wire fence with wooden posts. The path is covered with fallen leaves. The trees are tall and thin, with green foliage. The path leads towards a bright light at the end of the forest.

*Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway
Little Beaver Creek Greenway
Lisbon to Leetonia, Ohio*

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*Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway
Little Beaver Creek Greenway*

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Regional Trail Coalition

Industrial Heartland Trail

Pittsburgh to Georgetown
Washington D.C

Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



Three Rivers Heritage Trail Connection

- At the southern terminus the Ohio River Greenway Trail (ORGT) links to Allegheny County's 24-mile Three Rivers Heritage Trail via the Coraopolis to Pittsburgh Southside Connector.



Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



Three Rivers Heritage Trail Study

- ▶ Annual economic impact: 8.3 million
- ▶ Annual visits: 822,973
- ▶ Primary impact: Biking 44.1%



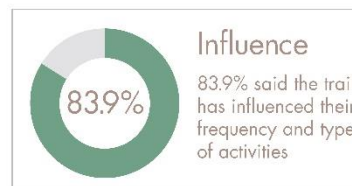


Highlights from the Three Rivers Heritage Trail 2014 User Survey and Economic Impact Report

Friends of the Riverfront is responsible for development and maintenance of the 24-mile Three Rivers Heritage Trail. Volunteers assist Friends of the Riverfront in its stewardship efforts. In 2014, 1,702 volunteers contributed 5,326 hours of service to Friends of the Riverfront at 50 Three Rivers Heritage Trail events. For more information, visit friendsoftheriverfront.org.

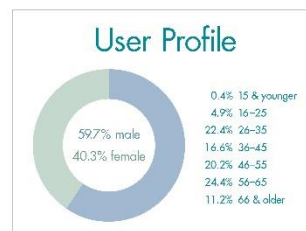
\$8.3 million

estimated total annual economic impact



822,873

Three Rivers Heritage Trail Visits Annually



©Friends of the Riverfront



pennsylvania
DEPARTMENT OF CONSERVATION
AND NATURAL RESOURCES
www.dcnr.state.pa.us

Rails-to-Trails Conservancy conducted the User Survey and Economic Impact Analysis. The report was developed with assistance from the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources, Bureau of Recreation and Conservation, Community and Conservation Partnership Program. The report was released March 27, 2015.

Three Rivers Heritage Trail



Three Rivers Heritage Trail



Three Rivers Heritage Trail



Three Rivers Heritage Trail

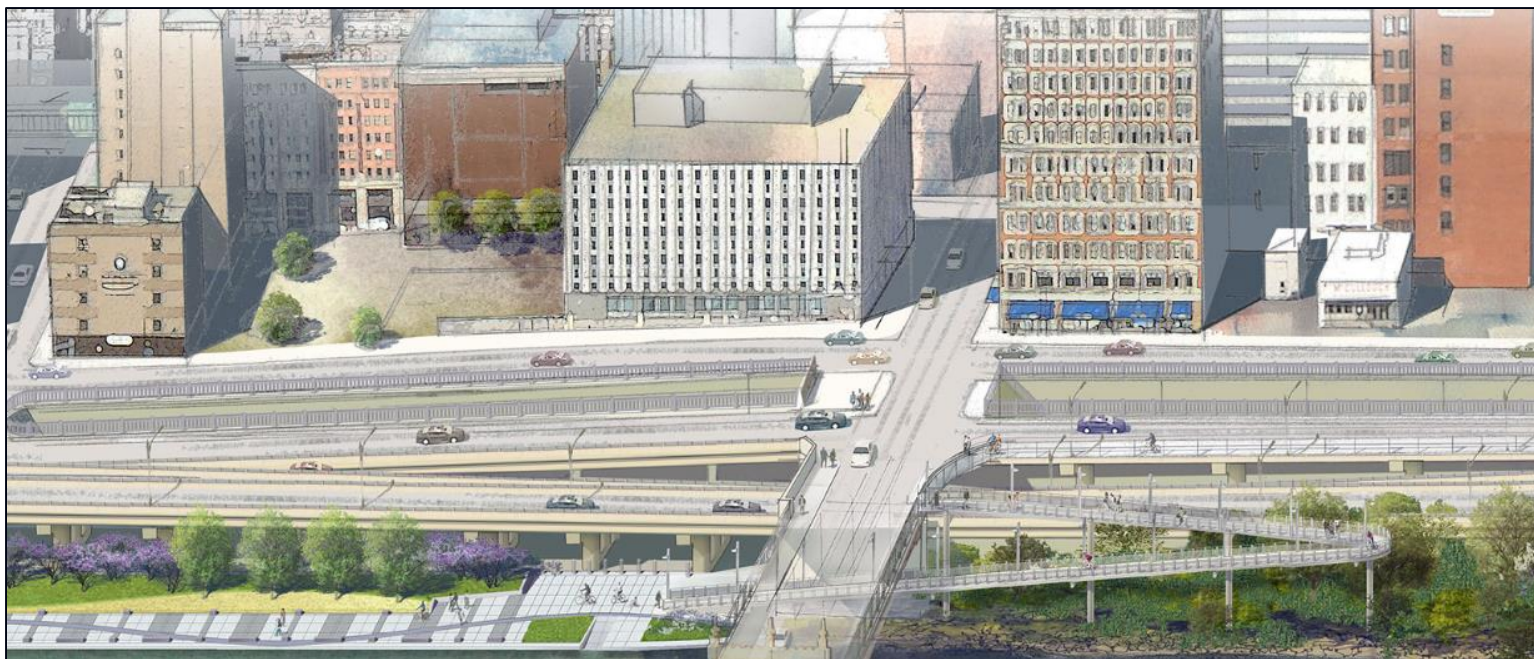


Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



Great Allegheny Passage

► Mon Wharf Switchback (2018)



Mon Wharf Switchback Ramp



Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



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Great Allegheny Passage

- ▶ The Mon Wharf Switchback connects trail users using the Smithfield Street Bridge, Three Rivers Heritage Trail and Great Allegheny Passage down to the eastern end of the Mon Wharf Landing, a linear park along the Monongahela River in downtown Pittsburgh.

Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



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Great Allegheny Passage

- The \$3.2 million Mon Wharf Switchback connects trail users using the Smithfield Street Bridge, Three Rivers Heritage Trail and Great Allegheny Passage down to the eastern end of the Mon Wharf Landing, a linear park along the Monongahela River in downtown Pittsburgh.

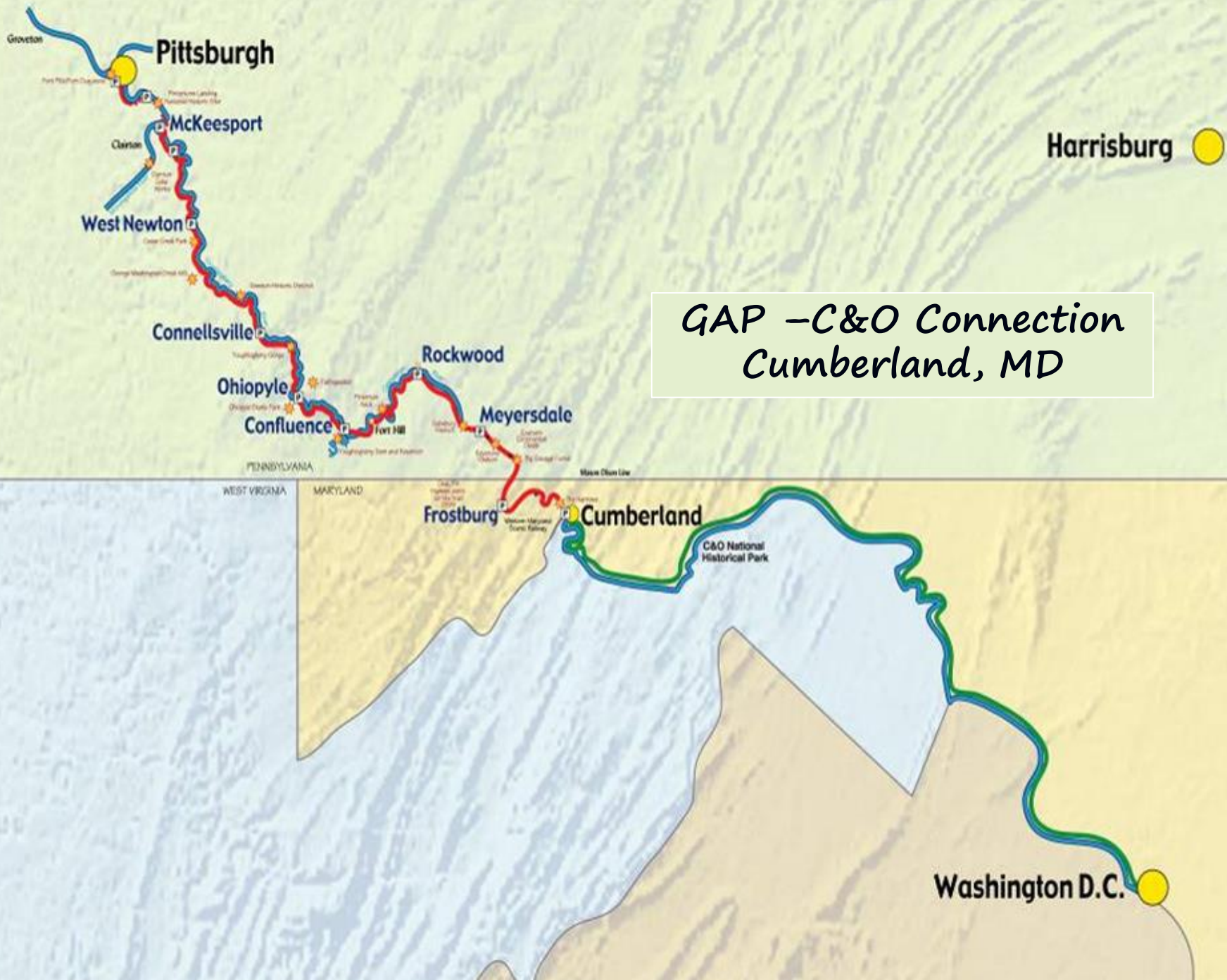
Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



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Great Allegheny Passage

- ▶ After 35 years of construction, the 150-mile Great Allegheny Passage was completed on Thursday, 6/13/2013.
- ▶ The GAP connects to the 184-mile C&O Canal Towpath in Cumberland, Md.
- ▶ Pittsburgh to Georgetown = 334 miles



*Great Allegheny Passage
High Bridge, Ohiopyle, Pa*



Great Allegheny Passage Big Savage Tunnel Prior to Rehabilitation



Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



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Great Allegheny Passage

- ▶ The former Western Maryland Railway's Big Savage Tunnel \$12 million rehabilitation investment was completed in 2005.



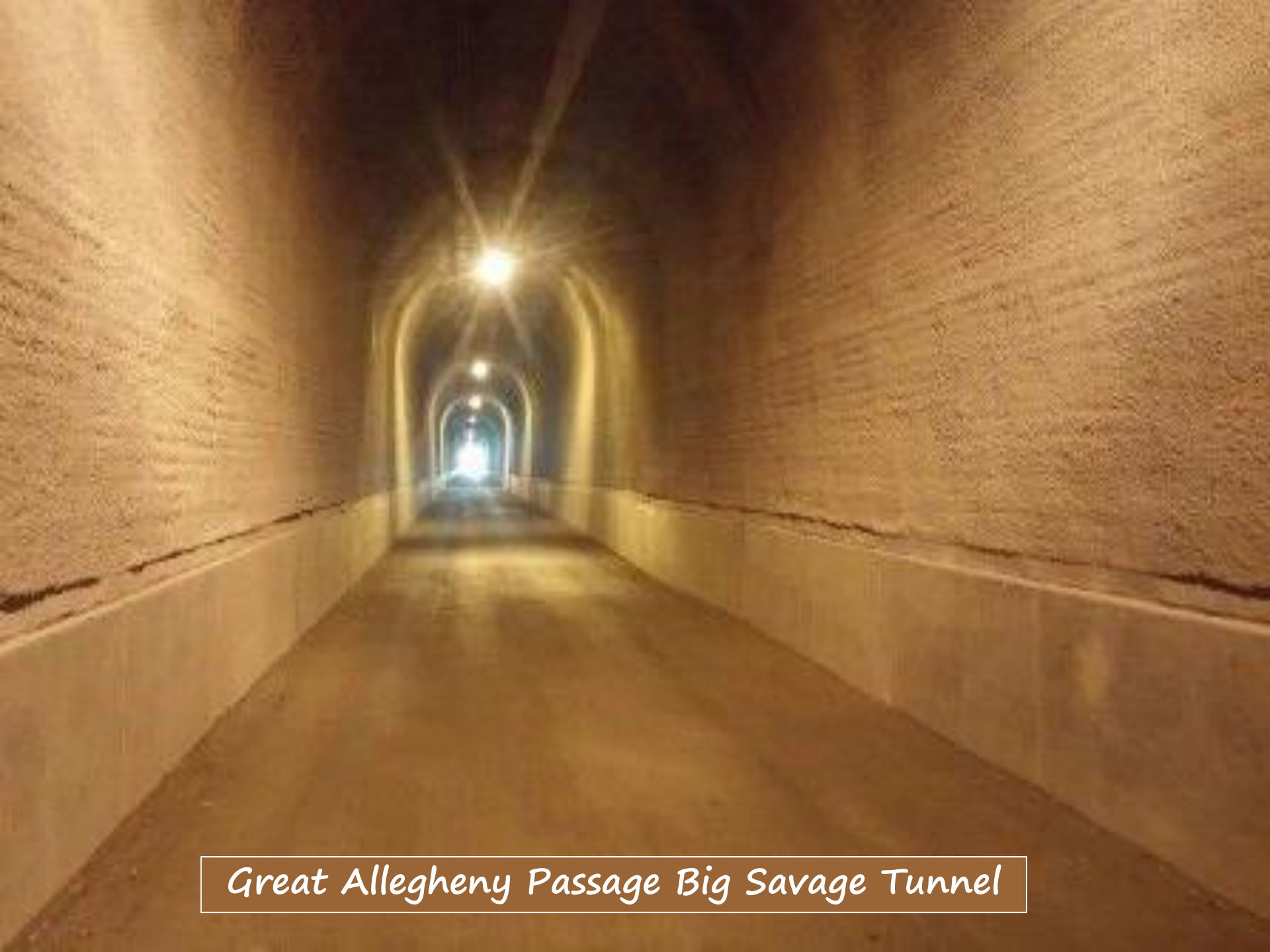
Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



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Great Allegheny Passage

- ▶ Big Savage Tunnel \$12 million funding sources:
 - ❖ DCNR – \$9 million
 - ❖ National Park Service - \$2 million
 - ❖ Allegheny Trail Alliance - \$1 million



Great Allegheny Passage Big Savage Tunnel

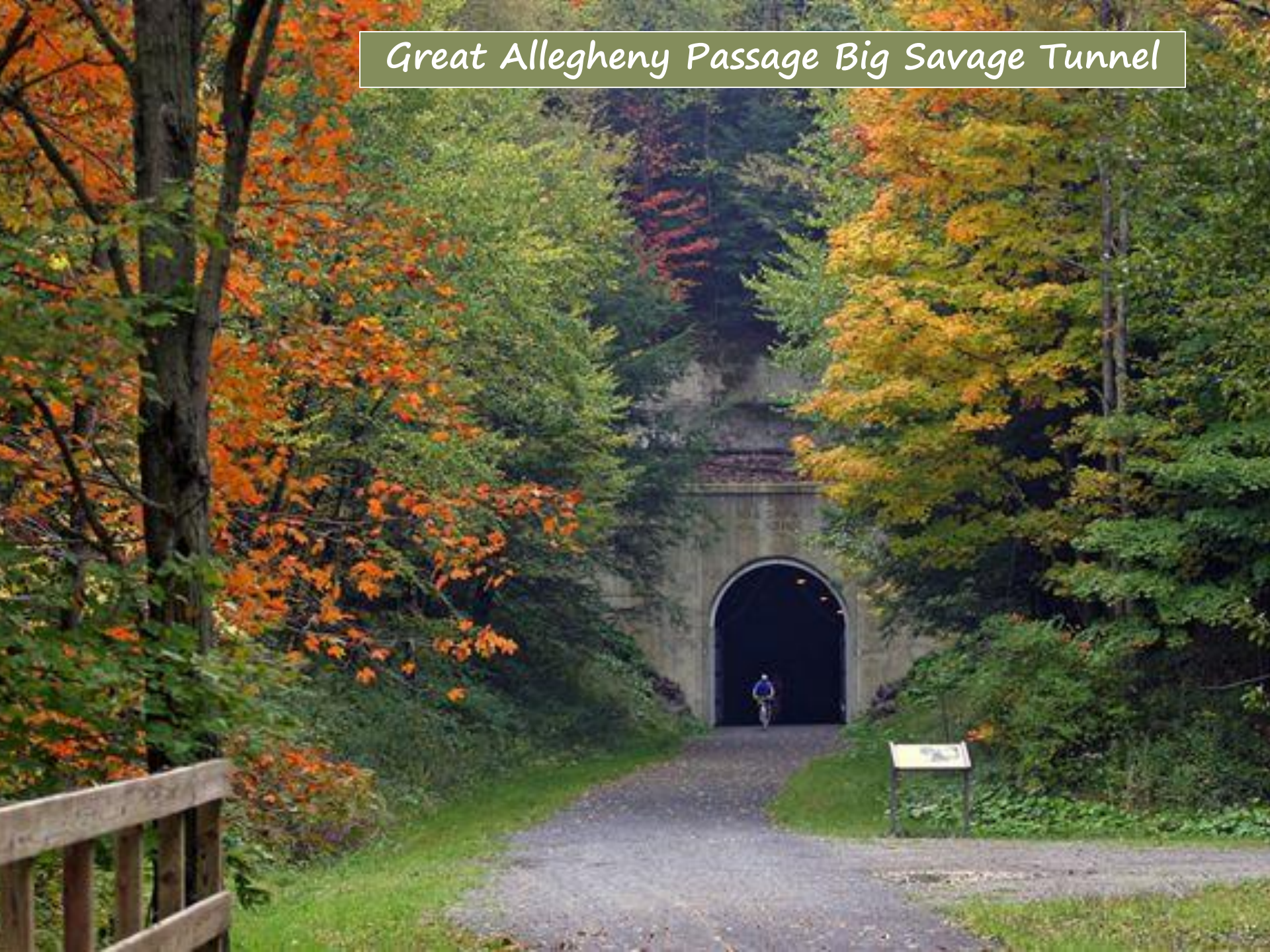
Great Allegheny Passage Big Savage Tunnel





Great Allegheny Passage Big Savage Tunnel

Great Allegheny Passage Big Savage Tunnel





*Big Savage Overlook
Great Allegheny Passage*

Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



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Great Allegheny Passage

- ▶ The GAP has demonstrated that greenways are significant economic generators.

**ECONOMIC
GROWTH**



Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



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Great Allegheny Passage

- ▶ Over \$50 million in direct annual spending and \$80 million in wages.
- ▶ With overnight visitors spending an average of \$114 per day.

Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



75

Great Allegheny Passage

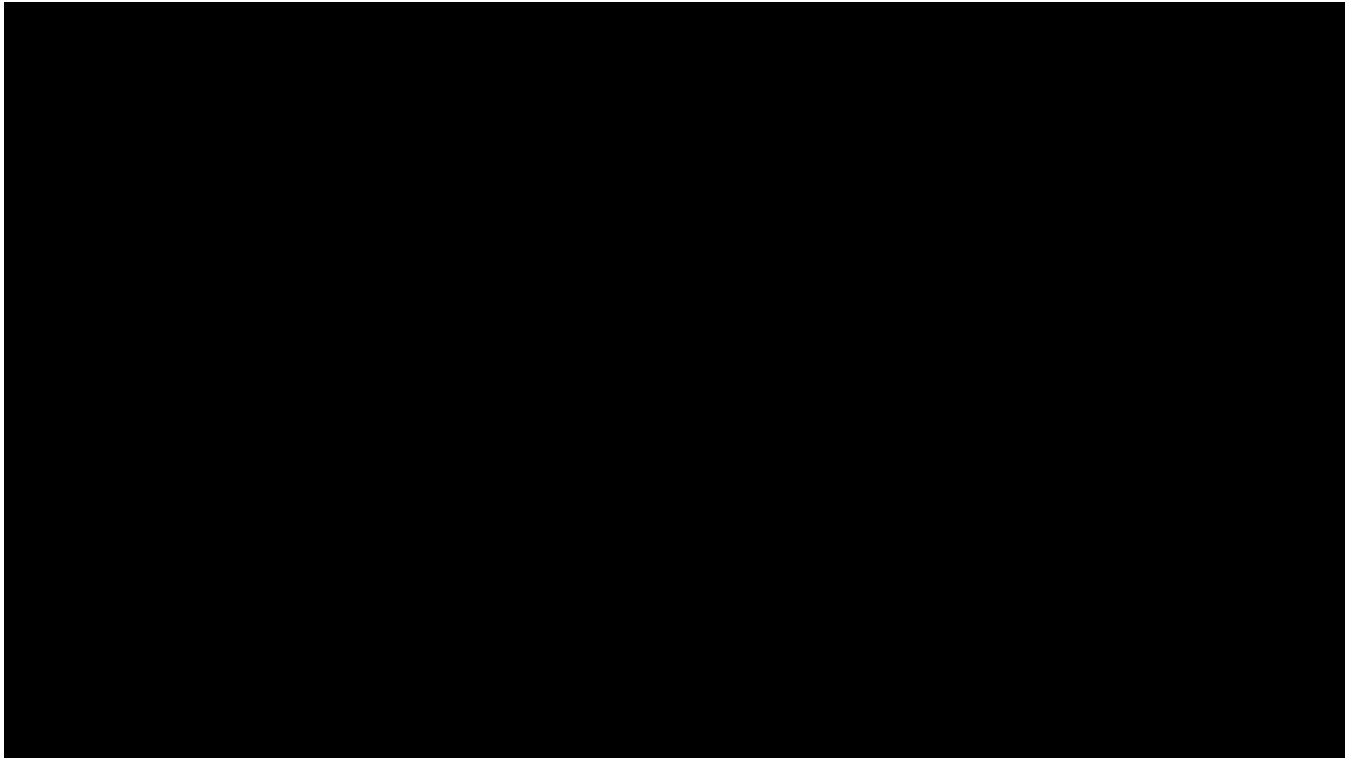
- ▶ Other Peoples Money (OPM)
- ▶ Rails-to-Trails Conservancy Video - <https://vimeo.com/50716802>



Regional Trail Coalition Pittsburgh to Georgetown



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Outdoor Recreation Strengthens Local Communities



THE OUTDOOR RECREATION ECONOMY GENERATES \$80 BILLION IN NATIONAL, STATE AND LOCAL TAX REVENUES EACH YEAR.

Cities and towns across the country are tapping into the business of outdoor recreation, and with good reason. They recognize that outdoor recreation and open spaces are key ingredients to healthy communities, contribute to a high quality of life, and most importantly, attract and sustain businesses and families.

National Bicycle Network

U.S. Bicycle Route System

Dr. Vincent Troia, CEO





National Bicycle Network

U.S. Bicycle Route System

U.S. Bicycle Routes



The goal of The United States Bicycle Route System is to connect America through a network of numbered interstate bicycle routes.

NATIONAL CORRIDOR PLAN

October 2018



 **DESIGNATED U.S. BICYCLE ROUTE**

Established U.S. Bicycle Route designated by AASHTO.

 **UNDEVELOPED CORRIDOR**

These corridors are not routes, but 50-mile wide areas where a route may be developed.

U.S. Bicycle Route System

U.S. Bicycle Route 50



U.S. Bike Route 50

- ▶ Form a national system that links urban, suburban, and rural areas.
- ▶ Must connect two or more states, a state and an international border, or other U.S. Bicycle Routes.



Adventure Cycling Association



National Bicycle Network

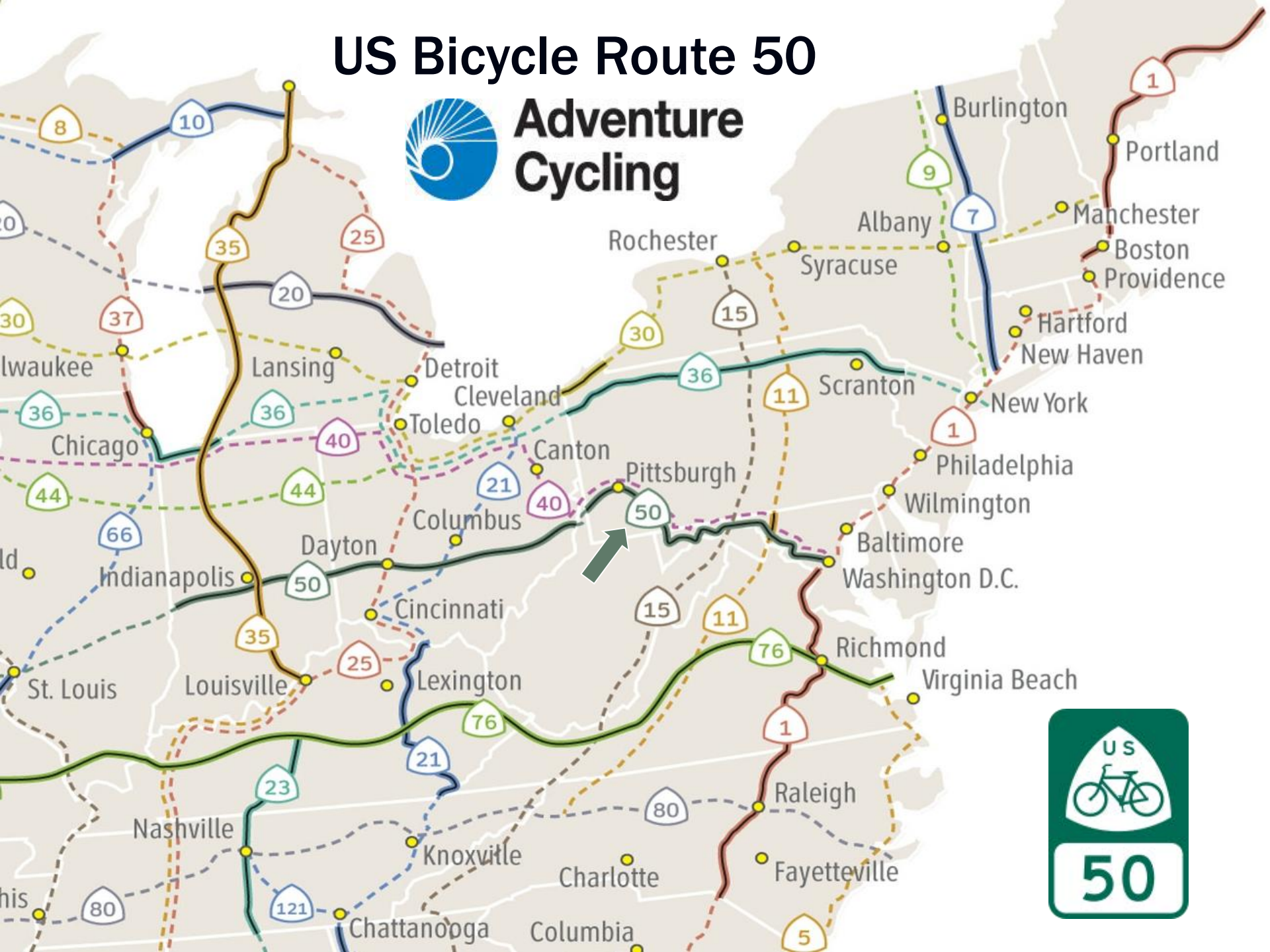
U.S. Bicycle Route System

U.S. Bicycle Route 50

US Bicycle Route 50



**Adventure
Cycling**



U.S. Bicycle Route System

U.S. Bicycle Route 50



U.S. Bike Route 50

- ▶ San Francisco to D.C.
- ▶ Three sections are completed:
 - ❖ a western section from South Lake Tahoe, California, to Border, Utah
 - ❖ a Midwestern section from Terre Haute, Indiana, to Steubenville, Ohio
 - ❖ an eastern section from Colliers, West Virginia, to Washington, D.C.

U.S. Bicycle Route System

U.S. Bicycle Route 50



U.S. Bike Route 50

- ▶ In PA USBR 50 mostly follows the *Panhandle* and *Montour* Trails and the *Great Allegheny Passage* as it crosses five counties to connect Colliers, West Virginia, with Frostburg, Maryland.

U.S. Bicycle Route System

U.S. Bicycle Route 50



Pennsylvania U.S. Bike Route 50

- ▶ BicyclePA Route S From West Newton to Rockwood Great Allegheny Passage
- ▶ BicyclePA Route A in Cecil Township, Pennsylvania



Adventure Cycling Association



National Bicycle Network

U.S. Bicycle Route System

Underground Railroad Bicycle Route

U.S. Bicycle Route System Underground Railroad



Underground Railroad Bicycle Route

- Created by the Center for Minority Health (CMH) at the University of Pittsburgh, in conjunction with the Adventure Cycling Association (ACA).



Adventure Cycling Association
America's Bicycle Travel Experts

U.S. Bicycle Route System Underground Railroad

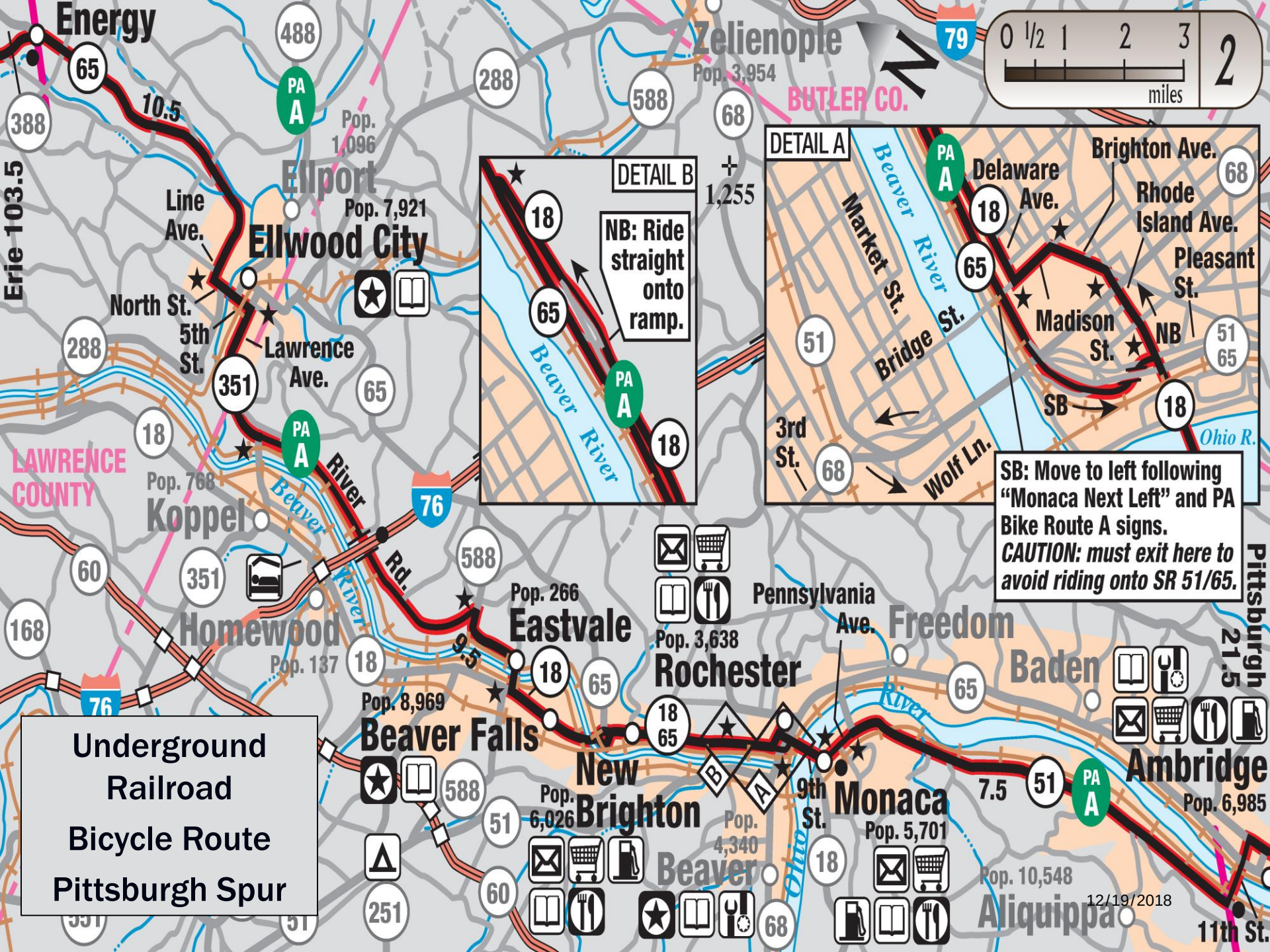


Underground Railroad Bicycle Route, Pittsburgh Spur







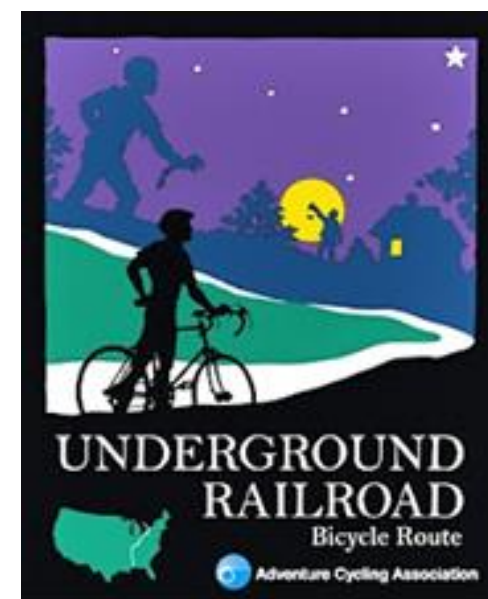


U.S. Bicycle Route System Underground Railroad



Underground Railroad Bicycle Route

- The Ohio River Greenway Trail follows or parallels part of the ACA Underground Railroad Bicycle Route, Pittsburgh Spur. (Pittsburgh, Pa to Erie, Pa)

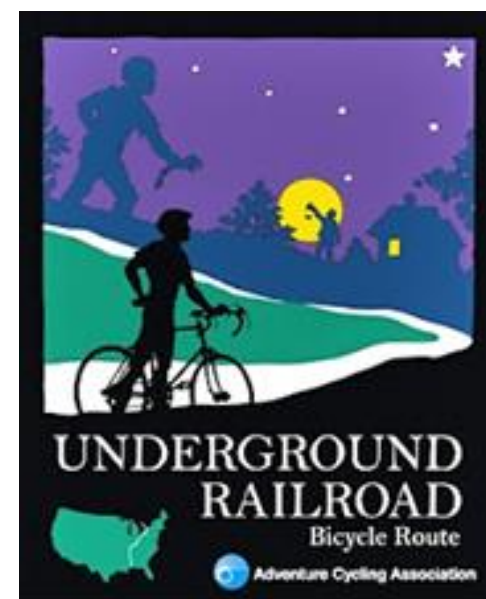


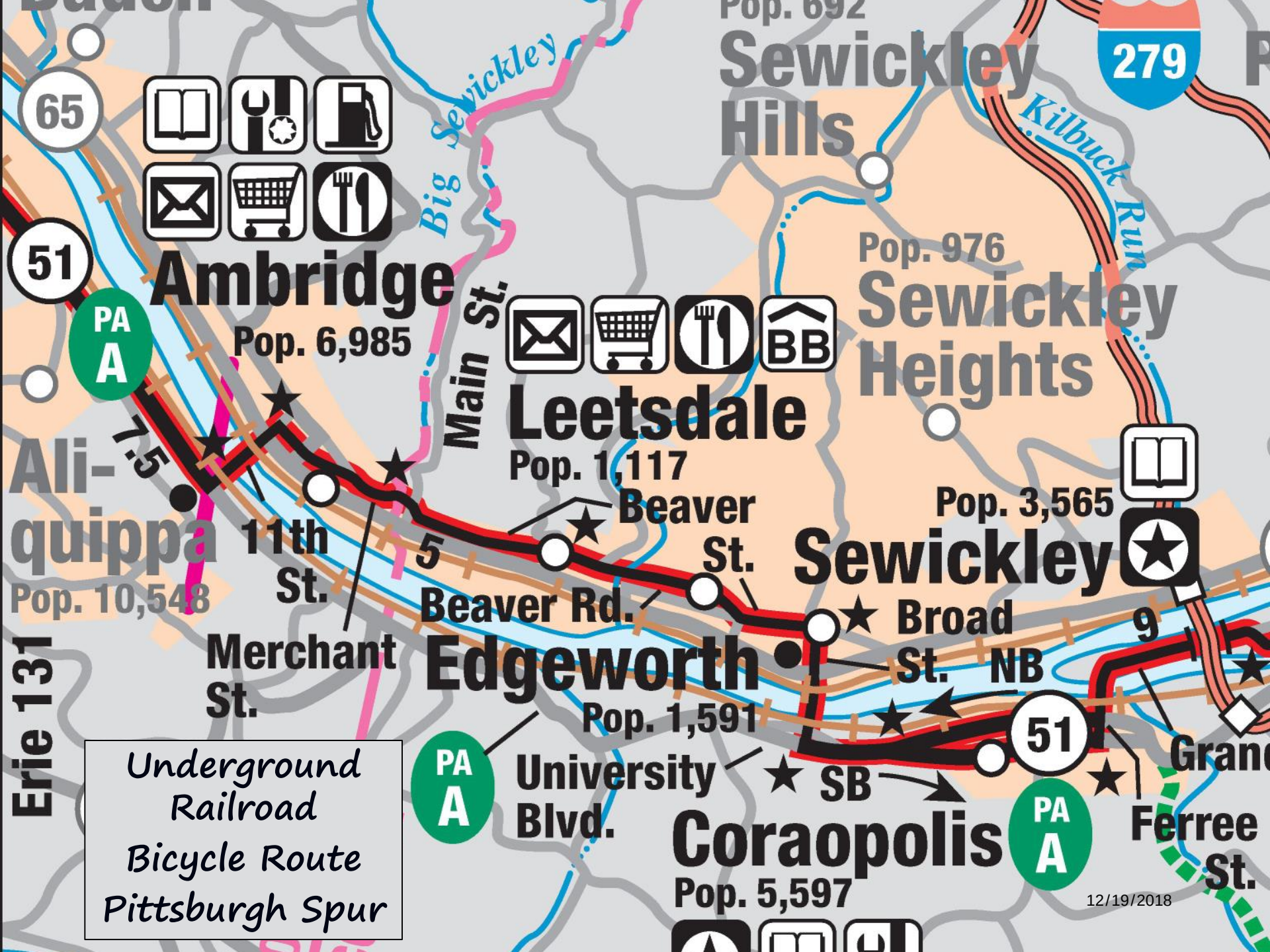
U.S. Bicycle Route System Underground Railroad

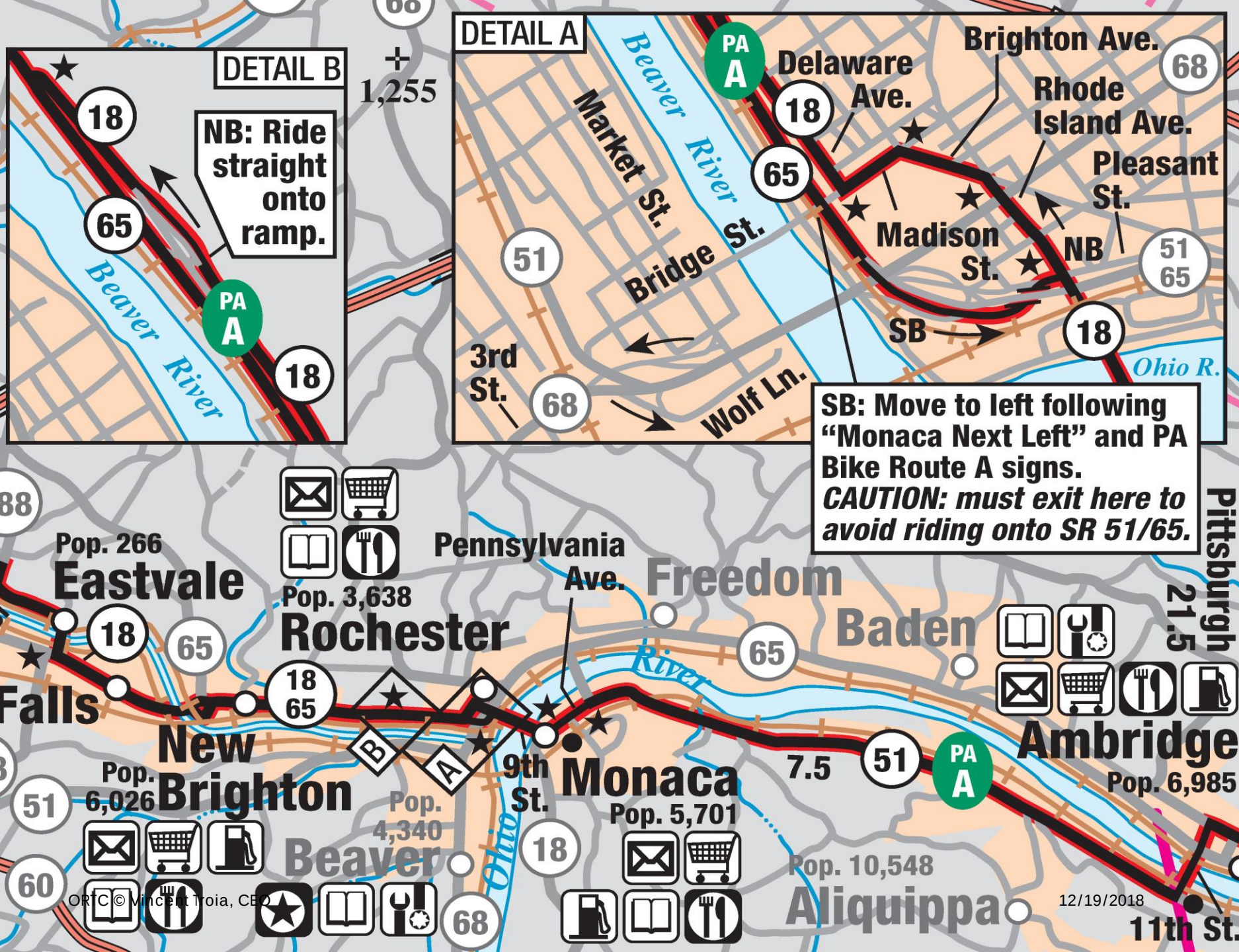


Underground Railroad Bicycle Route

- ▶ The ORGT follows or parallels part of the ACA Underground Railroad Bicycle Route, Pittsburgh Spur from Coraopolis to New Brighton.







Questions



Answers